

General Lit.





About the Course

Journey into the 19th century with novels, short stories, personal narratives, fairy tales, and more. Students engage with a variety of authors and texts from the time period and reflect on literary techniques and the characteristics of multiple genres along the way.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grade 9, Literature: Grade 10



Placement & Combining Tips

Suitable for hungry 8th graders. Can be combined easily with Grades 11-12.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9-10	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 2 times/week 30 min	Frankenstein Silas Marner Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass The Souls of Black Folk Up from Slavery Short stories and other writings

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 9				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 9		General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Poetry Study: Grade 9	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Plays: Grades 9-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 10				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 10 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12		General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	Poetry Study: Grade 10	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Plays: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

General Lit.: Grades 9-10



Frankenstein



Silas Marner



Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass



The Souls of Black Folk



Up from Slavery

Short stories and other writings



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

General Lit.: Grades 9-10

∞ [Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF](#)

Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

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General Lit.: Grades 9-10

How To Approach



Read

The lesson plans will guide you through what to read over the terms. Take a moment before reading to remember where you left off last time.



Narrate

The lesson plans will give you specific instructions or tell you to choose a way to narrate that helps you interact with the ideas.



Discuss

The lesson plans will guide you with questions or instructions to share your ideas or what you are reading with others.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are occasionally added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. Literature lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where student can share their ideas.



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 1

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ INTRO

Mary Shelley's *Frankenstein* has had a continuous influence on the wider culture since its publication over two centuries ago. Sir Walter Scott pronounced it "extraordinary" and declared that Shelley possessed "uncommon powers of poetic imagination." The story has been told and retold through many adaptations and artistic forms; however, there is a disconnect between the cartoonish, green-faced Frankenstein monster familiar to most of us and Shelley's tale of a nameless monster created by Dr. Frankenstein. Karen Swallow Prior writes that the novel "is full of surprises for the first-time reader." Rather than a straightforward monster story, it is "in the strain of the philosophical novel. Readers expecting merely an entertaining tale of horror can expect to be confronted with big ideas and big questions" (14).

→ READ & NARRATE

p.1-7 "You will rejoice" - "my beloved sister!"

- Notice that the novel opens with a series of letters. There will be many narrative frames throughout the novel as characters tell stories within stories, so paying attention to the point of view is very important. What do you learn of Robert Walton from these opening pages?
- What tone is set by the opening line?

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 2

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ INTRO (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass is a classic 19th-century autobiography that details the author's story from slavery to freedom. Douglass was born enslaved in Maryland in 1818 and escaped to freedom when he was around twenty years old. He went on to have a remarkable life as a national leader of the abolitionist movement, writer, orator, and statesman.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-7 "I was born in Tuckahoe" - "a good overseer."

- What do we learn about Frederick Douglass's family in this opening reading?
- What initial impressions do you have of his narrative style? How might this be connected to his aims for this autobiography? Consider in particular how he describes the more difficult and violent episodes from his childhood.

→ INTRO (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

Today, we begin reading the autobiography of Booker T. Washington. It was first written as a periodical, but was later put into book form. Washington was born a slave, but was still a child when emancipation occurred. He later founded Tuskegee Institute in Alabama and spent his life advancing the cause of equal rights. His writings give a window into the Reconstruction period that followed the American Civil War.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

★ TEACHER NOTE

Sensitive content: Douglass's *Narrative* contains several graphic descriptions of beatings and racial slurs.



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Ch.1 p.1-11 "I was born" - "owners as to the future."

- How does Washington describe his childhood? How does he describe the day of emancipation?

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 3

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.8-14 "So strange an accident" - "and wrecked it - thus!"

- How are the gigantic creature and the stranger introduced? What questions do you have at this point in the novel?
- What are Walton's impressions of his guest? Why would Shelley introduce the title character to her readers through another character?

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 4

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.7-13 "The home plantation" - "stone-like coolness."

- Reflect on Douglass's descriptions of the slave's songs. What purposes does singing serve? How has it been misunderstood?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2-3 p.11-22 "After the coming of freedom" - "or a handkerchief."

- Why were names so important to Washington and the other newly freed people?
- How does Washington describe the conditions of formerly enslaved people immediately after emancipation?
- How is education described in this chapter? Why did Washington see it as so important?

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 5

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.14-21 "I am by birth" - "the greatest avidity."

- Describe the circumstances of Victor's parentage, his childhood, and his education.

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



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- How does Victor recall his first reading of Agrippa? Does this foreshadow any of what is to come? Look for other instances of foreshadowing as you read.

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 6

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.13-19 "His savage barbarity" - "voice of tranquil music."

- Why do you think it is important for his narrative that Douglass describes violence in such detail? How does it strengthen his anti-slavery argument?
 - Why was leaving Colonel Lloyd's plantation such a turning point for Douglass?
-

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3-4 p.22-34 "Finally, the great day came" - "get through the school year."

- What hardships does he encounter while traveling, and how does he respond to them? Where does he find the strength to persevere?
- Describe Mrs. Ruffner and how she impacted his life. Who else had an impact on Washington?

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 7

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.21-29 "When I returned" - "my future destiny."

- When Victor goes to university, how do his professors react to his course of study?
- Where do you see foreshadowing in today's reading? Since Victor is telling Walton (who is retelling his story to his sister) about his past from the vantage point of the future, how reliable is he as a narrator?

- COMPOSITION - Compare/Contrast Karen Swallow Prior observes that "The clash between ancient and modern science is part of a larger discussion during this period of modernity. How are these two schools contrasted and set against one another? How is the modern elevated above the ancient? Do we still see this kind of debate today? How so?"

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 8

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.19-26 "But alas!" - "learning how to write."



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- How did Douglass's experiences with the Aulds set him "on the pathway from slavery to freedom"? Why did Mr. Auld forbid his wife to teach Douglass to read, and what did Douglass learn from this about literacy?
- How does Douglass teach himself to read and write? What obstacles does he face, and what does he learn about his own situation from what he reads?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4-6 p.34-50 "Three weeks before" - "features of the institution."

- Why does he believe education should include both academic learning and practical skills? How does Washington begin helping other members of his community?
- What opportunities and challenges arose for formerly enslaved people during the Reconstruction period? What aspects is Washington most critical of?
- What does Washington learn from his experience working with Native Americans?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 9

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Victor's education from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.29-36 "From this day" - "not have conceived."

- What are some clues that Victor is transgressing a necessary and sacred ethical boundary with his research? If "a churchyard was to [him] merely the receptacle of bodies deprived of life," (p.30) what does this tell us about his view of human beings?
- How does Victor describe the final "accomplishment of [his] toils"? What is his reaction when he comes face-to-face with what he created? How does the creature react to him?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 10

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.26-33 "In a very short time" - "sagacity to see it."

- What was Douglass's and the other slaves' situation when his master, Captain Anthony, died? How does Douglass's direct description of valuation strengthen his argument against slavery?
- What is Douglass's life like once he lives with Thomas Auld?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?



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→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7-8 p.51-64 "During the time" - "deeply as this one."

- What challenges did Washington face when he went to Tuskegee? What do we learn about his leadership style from how he faced these difficulties?
- Why does Washington praise manual labor so highly? What episodes from his younger years influenced the importance he placed on this type of work?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 11

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the creature's first moments from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.36-43 "I passed the night" - "I intreat you, write!"

- Throughout this process, Victor has isolated himself from friends and family and now refuses to confess to anyone what he has done. What does this say about his character, and how has it shaped his thinking and reactions?
- What news is contained in Elizabeth's letter? How does the story of Justine parallel other stories we have heard so far?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 12

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.33-39 "While I lived with my master" - "myself to my wretched lot."

- Why does Douglass call Edward Covey a "slave breaker"? What methods does Covey use to control enslaved people?
- How does Douglass describe the physical and emotional effects of his time with Covey?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9-10 p.64-74 "The coming of Christmas" - "or perhaps could build."

- How did the community support the school in Tuskegee?
- Why is it important for Washington to teach his students to "love work for its own sake" (72)?
- What lesson did Washington learn from brick-making about racial relations?

★ TEACHER NOTE
Sensitive content in a quotation: Up From Slavery p.68.



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WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 13

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Victor's state of mind from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.43-50 "Dear, dear Elizabeth!" - "not murdered my brother?"

- How does Victor now spend his time? Nature seems to have a way of restoring his "health and spirits," but do you find his description of nature as "inanimate" to be concerning (45)? How do his views of nature align or contrast with the view of nature put forth by Romanticism?
- What is the symbolism of the storm, and why is Victor so insistent on watching it rather than rushing home to his family?
- What do we learn about the creature with this next sighting of him?

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 14

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.39-45 "I have already intimated" - "practice is a very common one."

- Why do you think Douglass describes "this battle with Mr. Covey [as] the turning point in my career as a slave"?
- How does Douglass describe the celebration of Christmas for slaves as a tool of control rather than genuine kindness? How does this description support his anti-slavery argument?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.10-11 p.74-85 "The same principle" - "button is to be found missing."

- What challenges did Washington continue to face in setting up Tuskegee? How did he face them, and what can you learn from his perseverance?
- What were some lessons that Washington was trying to teach the students beyond the classroom?

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 15

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the circumstances surrounding William's death from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.50-58 "No one can conceive" - "yet I could not refuse."



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- Why does Victor not tell anyone his story if it could save the life of Justine?
- What do we learn about the character of Elizabeth from today's reading?

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 16

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.45-52 "On the first of January" - "we succeeded very well."

- How does this section show the hypocrisy between the slave-holders' professions of Christianity and their actions?
- How does Douglass describe his time with Mr. Freeland?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

(We are skipping chapters 12-13.)

Ch.14 p.105-115 "The Atlanta Exposition" - "exact justice to both races."

- What does Washington mean by "Cast down your bucket where you are"?
- How would you describe the overall message of his speech? How was it received?

→ LISTEN

The only audio recording of Booker T. Washington in existence is him reading the opening paragraphs of his Atlanta Exposition Speech in 1905.
∞ Audio Link: Booker T. Washington's "Atlanta Compromise" Speech

→ WATCH

This short biography of Booker T. Washington also introduces the debate with W. E. B. Du Bois, which will be the focus of the next three lessons.
∞ Video Link: Booker T. Washington: Founder of Tuskegee University & Champion for Civil Rights

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 17

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the circumstances surrounding William's death from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.58-65 "We entered the gloomy prison" - "giver of oblivion."

- From Karen Swallow Prior: "What is Justine's place in the family? What is her character like? How does her presence invoke issues of class and economic status?"
- Victor reflects: "Despair! Who dared talk of that? The poor victim, who



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on the morrow was to pass the awful boundary between life and death, felt not, as I did, such deep and bitter agony." What do you make of this? What does it say about Victor's sense of himself?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 18

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or The Souls of Black Folk

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.52-58 "After a painful waiting" - "Christian city of Baltimore."

- What is Douglass's plan to escape to freedom? What happens?
- How does Douglass's experience working at the shipyard demonstrate the injustices of the law?

→ INTRO (OPTION 2: THE SOULS OF BLACK FOLK)

W. E. B. Du Bois was a prominent writer, sociologist, historian, and advocate for civil rights. He was raised in Massachusetts and attended Fisk University and then Harvard, where he became the first African American to receive a PhD. He devoted his life to working for full equality for African Americans.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-7 "The Forethought" & Chapter 1: Of Our Spiritual Strivings

- Compare his aims and writing style to Washington's: what are some similarities and differences?
- Du Bois introduces two significant metaphors in today's reading: his concept of the "Veil" and of "double consciousness." How would you explain them to someone?

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 19

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Victor's state of mind after Justine's death from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.65-73 "I spent the following day" - "and fell asleep."

- What is Victor's relationship to nature in this section? If you have read Percy Shelley's poem "Mont Blanc," do you see any similarities?
- What are your first impressions of hearing the creature speak? Did any of it surprise you?
- The creature declares, "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend" (p.69). If you have read Paradise Lost, do you recognize any echoes of Milton's epic in today's reading? In the original 1818 version, Shelley included a quotation from Paradise Lost as an epigram ("Did I request thee, Maker, from my Clay / To mould me Man? Did I solicit thee / From darkness to promote me?")



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WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 20

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or The Souls of Black Folk

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.58-63 "Master Hugh, finding he could" - "for the reasons before mentioned."

- Why doesn't Douglass provide more details about how he escaped?
- What does it mean for Douglass to "hire his time," and how does this practice reinforce the injustices of slavery?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: THE SOULS OF BLACK FOLK)

What do you recall from your reading last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.18-25 Chapter 3: Of Booker T. Washington and Others

- How does Du Bois describe Washington's life and work?
- What are some of his critiques of the "Atlanta Compromise" and Washington's priorities?
- Compare the two men's views on education: what kinds of education do they each advocate?

★ TEACHER NOTE

For more background on Booker T. Washington and W. E. B. Du Bois's differing views, the following overview from Yale's Teachers Institute is helpful if your students have additional questions.

∞ Link: Booker T. Washington and W. E. B. Du Bois: The Problem of Negro Leadership

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 21

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Victor's response to his creation from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.73-81 "It was noon when I awoke" - "anticipations of joy."

- How does the creature describe first experiencing consciousness? What are his first few days like?
- Why is the creature so adamant in learning language? What does he think it will do for him?

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 22

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or The Souls of Black Folk

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.63-69 "I have been frequently asked" - "with my labors to decide."

- How does Douglass describe the feeling of finally being free?
- What circumstances prompt him to begin speaking and working as an abolitionist?

• EXTRA HELPING

The poet Dudley Randall wrote a poem about the debate between Washington and Du Bois.

∞ Link: Booker T. and W.E.B.



Term 1	
→ VIEW Learn more about Frederick Douglass's later life. ∞ Video Link: Frederick Douglass: First African American Nominated for Vice President ----- → RECAP (OPTION 2: THE SOULS OF BLACK FOLK) What do you recall from last week's reading? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.31-36 Chapter 5: Of the Wings of Atalanta • Why does Du Bois draw on the myth of Atalanta and the golden apples in this chapter? • At the end of this chapter, he writes: "We are training not isolated men but a living group of men,—nay, a group within a group. And the final product of our training must be neither a psychologist nor a brickmason, but a man" (36). Can you explain what he means in your own words? What does this argument tell us about how he views the purpose of education?	
WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 23 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Frankenstein	
WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass OR Up from Slavery & The Souls of Black Folks	



Term 2

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 25

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the Creature's narrative of his first days from your reading last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.81-89 "I now hasten" - "plan of future maintenance."

- Describe the De Lancey family. Do they remind you of other stories you have heard in this narrative so far?
- How do the De Lanceys serve as a foster family and a virtuous example to follow for the Creature, even as they are unaware of his presence?

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 26

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ INTRO

The modernist writer Virginia Woolf once praised George Eliot's *Middlemarch* as "one of the few English novels written for grown-up people," and this suggestion of sophistication, psychological depth, and a moral imagination could equally apply to the next novel you will read in this course, *Silas Marner*. George Eliot, the pen name for Mary Ann Evans, described the novel to her publisher as "a sort of legendary tale" to which she decided to give "a more realistic treatment." As you read, look for how these strands of fairy tale or legend interweave with a realistic depiction of nineteenth-century English village life.

→ READ & NARRATE

p.5-13 "In the days when" - "been nowhere else."

- How would you describe the setting of Raveloe?
- What are your first impressions of Silas Marner? How does your first impression of him change as you read about his life fifteen years earlier in Lantern Hill?

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 27

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the De Lacey family from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.89-97 "Such were the events" - "unperceived to my hovel."

- How does the Creature interpret his own life through the reading he does?
- From Karen Swallow Prior: "Do you fault the De Lacey family for their reaction to the creature? Why or why not?"



Term 2

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 28

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What are your first impressions of the novel and Eliot's writing style based on what you read last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.13-20 "The search was made" - "Old Master Marner."

- How would you describe the religious community Silas is a part of in Raveloe?
- What details does Eliot include to emphasize the injustice of what happens to Silas? How does he respond to what happens to him?
- What has his life been like in the fifteen years since he arrived in Raveloe?

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 29

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Creature's conversation with De Lacey from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.97-105 "Cursed, cursed creator!" - "deny me my request!"

- How is the Creature's rescue of the drowning girl and her guardian's shooting of him a pivotal turning point in his narrative?
- What do you think Victor's response will be to the Creature's request?

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 30

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What are your first impressions of the novel and Eliot's writing style based on what you read last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.20-30 "Yet even in" - "fall on my legs."

- Why do you think Silas has an evening ritual of sorting and counting his money each night? What does the gold mean to him?
- How are members of the Cass family contrasted with Silas? What is the effect of contrasting a poor weaver counting his fortune with a Squire's family experiencing money problems?
- What can you tell about the brothers' relationship based on the way they speak to each other? How does Godfrey's secret create a power imbalance?

General Lit.: Grades 9-10

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Term 2

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 31

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Creature's final request to Victor from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.105-112 "I was moved" - "occupy the scene."

- Why does Victor's response to the monster vacillate between sympathy and disgust?
- From Karen Swallow Prior: "Structurally, Victor is pressed to make a mate for the creature and to marry Elizabeth at the same point in time. What is the significance as well as the effect of these two events coinciding in Victor's life?"

• **COMPOSITION - Point of View**
Frankenstein is written from several character's perspectives, but they are all 1st person POV. Retell Ch.XVII or another section from a different character's perspective. Then, retell the same selection from a 3rd person (outside) POV.

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 32

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What did you learn about the relationship between the Cass brothers from what you read last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.30-38 "With that, Dunstan slammed" - "Marner was not there."

- Can you make any predictions about Godfrey's future based on what you learn about him and his choices in today's reading?
- Eliot continuously places her characters into situations where they are given a clear moral choice to make. What choice does Dunstan face at the end of today's reading? What do you think he will do?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 33

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Victor's return home from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.112-120 "We travelled at" - "sicken in my bosom."

- How are descriptions of nature and travel connected with Victor's internal state of mind in this section?
- What role does Clerval play in the story?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 34

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

Where did we leave Dunstan Cass at the end of last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE



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p.38-45 "Nothing at that moment" - "that called for beer."

- Even though we know what has happened, how does Eliot's description of Silas's actions in chapter 5 build suspense?
- What is the significance of the fact that the loss of his gold requires Silas to return to the society of other people by going to the Rainbow? What does this say about loneliness, isolation, and the need for human connection?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 35

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Victor's travels with Clerval from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.120-127 "I sat one evening" - "to my recollection."

- Why does Victor ultimately decide to abandon his project and deny the Creature's request?
- How does Victor interpret the Creature's threat?
- What do you think is about to happen?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 36

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do you recall about how Silas reacted to the loss of his gold?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.46-54 "The conversation, which" - "of ghostly phenomena."

- You may not understand all the back-and-forths in this tavern conversation, but what sense do you get of provincial life in a nineteenth-century English village? What concerns do they have?
- How does Eliot's mimicking of individuals' styles of speech reveal details about their characters?

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 37

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the Creature's confrontation and threat to Victor from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.128-135 "I was soon introduced" - "I wept bitterly."

- How does Victor's story at this point parallel Justine's? How is it different?

General Lit.: Grades 9-10

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WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 38

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the conversation at the Rainbow from last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.55-62 "Yet the next moment" - "severe public duties."

- How do the various characters at the tavern react to Silas's news? Why is the robbery such a point of local interest and gossip?
- Are you noticing Silas's behavior beginning to change?

• COMPOSITION - Point of View

Choose one of the characters from the tavern (or invent your own), and retell the entrance of Silas Marner at the Rainbow from that individual's point of view.

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 39

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Victor's time in prison from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.135-143 "Ever since my recovery" - "cling to me forever."

- From Karen Swallow Prior: "Trace the role of Victor's father throughout this point in the novel. At one point, Victor describes him as 'indulgent.' Is this an accurate description? Does this turn out to be a helpful or destructive quality?"
- How does Victor feel as his wedding approaches? Do you recognize any warning signs or foreshadowing?

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 40

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.62-70 "Some disappointment was" - "a dishonest trick, sir."

- What does today's reading reveal about the character of Godfrey Cass? Do you find him to be morally weak or justified in hiding his secret?
- In what ways are Godfrey Cass and Silas Marner reflections and contrasts of each other?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 41

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Victor's state of mind as his wedding approaches from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.143-150 "It was eight o'clock" - "I know not how."



Term 2

- How is Elizabeth's death another turning point for Victor? What other victims are there of this murder?
- What happens when Victor finally tells his story to someone?
- Has Victor finally become like his creation at this point in the story, now that he is all alone in the world?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 42

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What insights did you get last week into the character of Godfrey Cass?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.70-79 "Where's Dunsey, then?" - "long while since."

- Godfrey hopes for "some unforeseen turn of fortune, some favorable chance which would save him from unpleasant consequences" - what is the role of chance/fate/fortune in the character's lives thus far?
- How has Silas's life been upended with the loss of his gold? How does he respond when the villagers begin to reach out to him? What does this tell us about his character?

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 43

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Victor's time in prison from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.150-158 "Amidst the wilds of Tartary and Russia" - "and I may die."

- After hearing his whole story, what is Walton's assessment of Victor? How has his story affected those who heard it?
- Why does Victor reject Walton's offering of friendship?
- How do you think the story will end?

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 44

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.79-86 "After receiving such" - "experience had become dim."

- Describe the character of Dolly Winthrop. How does she try to help Silas? What does she tell him about church, and how is her description different from the religious community of Lantern Hill?
- Eliot says of Silas, "the fountains of human love and of faith in a divine love had not yet been unlocked." How did he get to be this way? Do you see any foreshadowing in this sentence?

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Term 2

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 45

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Walton's letter to his sister from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.158-166 "I write to you" - "darkness and distance."

- Why do you think Shelley includes the mutiny plot and the decision to return to England at the end of the novel?
- How does Walton react to the Creature? How does he describe him?
- What do you think of the final image in the novel of the Creature "lost in darkness and distance." Is the story resolved? Or are there elements of the narrative that feel unfinished?
- Overall, what are your reflections on the novel?

• COMPOSITION - Descriptive

The narrative that frames Frankenstein - letters from Walton to his sister - takes place in the Arctic on a vessel bound for scientific exploration. From other reading you have done this year, what do you think is the significance of the Arctic as the setting of the final confrontation between creator and creation? How does it connect to other natural environments described in the novel?

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 46

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the character of Dolly from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.86-94 "But in Raveloe" - "to go down."

- How do the Christmas party preparations at the Red House contrast with the scenes just preceding of Silas's own Christmas?
- Give a brief character sketch of Nancy's sister Priscilla.

WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 47

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Frankenstein

WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 48

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Silas Marner



Term 3

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 49

"The Celebrated Jumping Frog of Calaveras County" by Mark Twain

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

We've included audio versions of these stories as an alternative to reading the written stories. Short stories can be especially fun to hear aloud with a talented narrator, though it will take longer than reading the story.

Mark Twain (1835–1910) is the pen name of Samuel Clemens, one of America's most celebrated writers, who was known for his sharp wit. His most famous works include *The Adventures of Tom Sawyer* and *Adventures of Huckleberry Finn*. Published in 1865, "The Celebrated Jumping Frog" was the story that made Twain a household name. The story blends exaggeration and comic timing in a way that was fresh and distinctly American when it was published. As you read, pay attention not just to what happens, but to how the story is told.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.2-5 "The Celebrated Jumping Frog of Calaveras County" by Mark Twain

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- What makes Simon Wheeler's way of telling his story just as funny as the story itself? Can you think of another story, movie, or TV show where the delivery matters as much as the punchline?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: Mark Twain bio

★ TEACHER NOTE

In the second week of this term, we'll read "The Gift of the Magi" by O. Henry, which is a Christmas story. Feel free to reschedule this story for closer to Christmas if desired.

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 50

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

We left the Lammeter sisters mid-conversation. Do you recall what was happening at the party?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.94-102 "'Sister,' said Nancy" - "very long coat-tails."

- In what ways are characters at the party concerned with status, reputation, and social expectations?
- What does the party reveal about the social structure and values of Raveloe society?

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 51

"The Gift of the Magi" by O. Henry

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

O. Henry was the pen name of William Sydney Porter (1862–1910), an American writer famous for his short stories about ordinary people — especially the working poor of New York City. His warm, ironic style made him one of the most popular writers of his era. Published in 1905, "The Gift of the Magi" is perhaps his most beloved story. If you have extra time, his biography (see video link) is especially interesting.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS



Term 3

Read (Or Listen): p.6-9 "The Gift of the Magi" by O. Henry
 ∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Were Jim and Della's sacrifices generous or just foolish? Why?
- Where did O. Henry plant clues about the twist ending? Did any of them tip you off while you were reading?

→ **VIEW (OPTIONAL)**

∞ Video Link: O. Henry bio

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 52

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ **RECAP**

What do you recall from the reading last week?

→ **READ & NARRATE**

p.102-109 "Already Mr. Macey" - "delicate, half-transparent lids."

- How does Nancy Lammeter behave at the party, and what does her behavior reveal about her personality and values?
- Why do you think Eliot set the New Year's party directly before the turning point in the novel?

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 53

"The Gold Bug" by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ **INTRO**

Edgar Allan Poe (1809–1849) is one of America's most distinctive and influential writers. Poe is known for dark, atmospheric tales of mystery and the macabre. Surprisingly, he also pioneered the detective story! Poe had a fascination with puzzles, codes, and the power of careful reasoning. Published in 1843, "The Gold Bug" is a mystery with a secret message written in code, and cracking it requires sharp eyes and sharp thinking. As you read, pay close attention when the cipher appears and to how the code is broken. If you'd like, see if you can work through it yourself!

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.10-17 (stop at "we shall see!")

- How would you describe Legrand and Jupiter from what you've read so far?

→ **VIEW (OPTIONAL)**

∞ Video Link: Edgar Allan Poe bio

★ TEACHER NOTE

"The Gold Bug" contains a repeated racial slur. Please preview for your students.

If you have already read this story, you may substitute "The Old Nurse's Story" by Elizabeth Gaskell. (Also included in the PDF for this course on p.38-50)

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 54

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ **RECAP**

What did you learn last week about Godfrey's wife in the brief moments she is in the novel?

→ **READ & NARRATE**

p.109-117 "But where was" - "story of this night."

- What is the significance of Silas mistaking the sleeping child for gold?



Term 3

- What do you make of the line "at the end of sixteen years every line in the worn face was present to him when he told the full story of this night"? What is Eliot hinting will happen to Godfrey's secret?

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 55

"The Gold Bug" by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next during their adventure?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.17-23 "We crossed the creek" - "we had been digging."

- Does the narrator believe Legrand? What does he think has happened to Legrand? Do you agree?

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 56

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.117-125 "He turned immediately" - "she had joy."

- How does Godfrey react when faced with a moral choice?
- What is the significance of Silas's fits? How have they impacted the narrative thus far? Why do you think Eliot would choose to give Silas this affliction?
- How does the presence of the child begin to change Silas?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 57

"The Gold Bug" by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ RECAP

What has happened so far during their adventure, especially while at the tree?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.23-29 "Around the new position" - "place of deposit."

- The narrator immediately demands an explanation rather than simply celebrating when the treasure is found. Why do you think this is?
- We are told very little about who the narrator is. What do you know so far? Why do you think we are told so little?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 58

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do recall about Silas's relationship with the child from your reading last week?



Term 3

→ READ & NARRATE

p.125-133 "And when the sunshine" - "a father's duty."

- How does Silas parent Eppie? What decisions does he make that are different than Dolly suggests? What is the result?
- What elements of fairy tale or legend have you noticed in the story thus far?
- What do you think of Godfrey's choices? Would you have had him act differently?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 59

The Gold Bug by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ RECAP

What "links" of logic has Legrand revealed so far?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.30-37

- How much of finding the treasure was logic and how much was luck, in your opinion?

• COMPOSITION

"The Gold Bug" is considered an early template for detective fiction. What elements fit that mold? What's missing that later detective stories (such as Sherlock Holmes) add?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 60

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.137-144 "It was a bright" - "was sitting still."

- How have the characters changed after sixteen years? Did anything surprise you?

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 61

"The Tale of the Golden Cockerel" by Pushkin

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Alexander Pushkin (1799–1837) is Russia's most celebrated and beloved writer, widely considered the father of modern Russian literature. His poetry, novels, and stories established the literary tradition that nearly every Russian writer after him would build upon. Written in 1834, "The Tale of the Golden Cockerel" is one of his narrative poems written in the style of a Russian folktale. The story reads like a fairy tale but carries the sharp edge of a fable. As you read, ask yourself who holds the real power in this story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.51-56 "The Tale of the Golden Cockerel" by Pushkin

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- What kind of ruler is the king at the beginning of the story, and does your opinion of him change as the story progresses?



Term 3

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Web Link: Alexander Pushkin bio

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 62

Silas Marner

📄 Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the characters sixteen years later from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.144-150 "Dolly was too useful" - "much at once."

- How has Dolly helped Silas recover from what was done to him at Lantern Hill?
- Describe the character of Eppie. What kind of young woman has she grown up to be?

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 63

"How Much Land Does a Man Need?" by Leo Tolstoy

📄 Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Leo Tolstoy (1828–1910) is best known for lengthy novels like War and Peace and Anna Karenina. But Tolstoy was also a master of the short story, and late in his life he turned increasingly toward simple, moral tales. Published in 1886, "How Much Land Does a Man Need?" is one of those tales. As you read, watch for how Tolstoy uses one man's desires to build suspense and make his argument.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.57-68 "How Much Land Does a Man Need?" by Leo Tolstoy

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- At the end of the story, the title's question is answered. Did the answer surprise you, or did you see it coming? Why?

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 64

Silas Marner

📄 Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Silas's relationship with grown-up Eppie from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.151-158 "While Silas and Eppie" - "in other ways."

- What has happened to Nancy and Godfrey over the past sixteen years? What is their relationship like now?
- What makes Silas a stronger parent to Eppie than Godfrey, despite lacking wealth or social status?



Term 3

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 65

"The Kingdom of Cards" by Rabindranath Tagore

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Rabindranath Tagore (1861–1941) was a Bengali poet, writer, and philosopher from India who became the first non-European writer to win the Nobel Prize in Literature, receiving it in 1913. He was a prolific writer of poetry, short stories, novels, and plays, and is still considered one of the greatest literary figures of the modern era. His short story "The Kingdom of Cards" is written in the style of a fairy tale and uses an imaginary world to say something true about the real one.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.69-74 "The Kingdom of Cards" by Rabindranath Tagore

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Would you want to live in the Kingdom of Cards? What does your answer say about what you value?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 66

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Nancy and Godfrey's marriage from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.158-164 "This possibility was" - "at the stone pits."

- What does the chapter suggest about responsibility and timing? Can some mistakes be corrected too late?
- What does Dunstan's fate suggest about Eliot's moral vision in the novel?
- How does Nancy's reaction to Godfrey's confession reveal her moral character?

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 67

"The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Arthur Conan Doyle (1859–1930) was a British writer (born in Edinburgh, Scotland) and best known as the creator of Sherlock Holmes, arguably the most famous fictional detective in the world. He was knighted by King Edward VII in 1902. The Holmes stories defined the modern detective story and have never gone out of print. "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" is widely considered one of the finest Holmes stories ever written. As you read, pay attention to the clues Doyle plants along the way, and see how much you can figure out before he reveals the answer.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.75-85 "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Julia's mysterious dying words are "the speckled band"! Why do you think a dying clue is such a common device in detective fiction?

• COMPOSITION

Holmes asks Watson to come along to Stoke Moran, warning him there will be danger. Why do you think Watson agrees to come? Is Watson loyal, brave, or does he simply trust Holmes?



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- Helen has been moved into her dead sister's room because of renovations, and this makes Holmes suspicious. Why do you think Helen herself didn't question it more?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: Arthur Conan Doyle bio

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 68

Silas Marner

📄 Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the discovery at the Stone-pits from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.165-173 "Between eight and" - "unable to say more."

- Eliot describes Silas's face as showing a "sort of transfiguration, as he sat in his armchair and looked at Eppie" after the discovery of his gold. What other transfigurations have occurred in the novel?
- How does the reveal of Eppie's parentage to her by the Casses touch on some of Eliot's broader themes in the novel?
- What role does free choice play in Eppie's decision about her future?

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 69

"The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

📄 Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.86-95 "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Holmes notices what others ignore. Is that a matter of intelligence, training, habit, or something else entirely?
- Arthur Conan Doyle considered this the best of all his Sherlock Holmes stories. (You can read his top 12 at the link below.) What do you think makes it so enduring? How does it compare to Poe's "The Gold-Bug" (written almost 50 years prior) as a piece of detective fiction?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Link: Arthur Conan Doyle's Favorite Sherlock Holmes Stories

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 70

Silas Marner

📄 Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.174-183 "Nancy and Godfrey" - "happier than we are."

- How has Lantern Hill changed in the intervening years? How have time, distance, and age altered Silas's memory of his former home?
- Why might George Eliot choose not to give Silas complete answers

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about William Dane's betrayal? • What do you think of the ending of the novel? What message do you think Eliot wants us to take away from her work?	
WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 71 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Short Stories and Folk Tales	
WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 72 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Silas Marner	

General Lit.: Grades 9-10

Examination

Term 1

· Frankenstein: How are the feelings Walton describes having toward Frankenstein—such as sympathy, compassion, admiration, and pity—significant to other relationships in the novel? OR Discuss the role nature plays in the novel so far, and how it is connected to various characters' internal states.

· Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass: Explain why reading and literacy were such an important first step in Douglass's path from slavery to freedom. OR Describe some of the ways Douglass's Narrative is such a powerful argument against slavery.

Up from Slavery & The Souls of Black Folk: Describe Washington's and Du Bois's differing views on the purpose of education. OR Tell all you know about Washington's early life and how it impacted his future leadership at the Tuskegee school.

Term 2

· Frankenstein: One of the components in the classical definition of tragedy is that a great hero is brought down by a fatal flaw in his character. If we read the novel as the tragedy of Victor Frankenstein, what is his fatal flaw? Or would you read it as a tragedy of another character instead?

OR

Frankenstein: From Karen Swallow Prior: How do the lines spoken by the creature to Victor upon their first meeting encapsulate the entire novel? "Remember, that I am thy creature: I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel, whom thou drivest from joy for no misdeed. Everywhere I see bliss, from which I alone am irrevocably excluded. I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous."

· Silas Marner: What does the gold symbolize to Marner in the beginning of the story, and how does its loss begin to change him? OR By placing characters into situations requiring moral actions, how does Eliot shape the ethical imagination of her readers?

Term 3

· Short Stories and Folk Tales: Choose one story from this term that ends with a "twist" and explain how its ending works. What does it reveal? Why is it effective? What do you think the author most wanted you to take away? OR Poe's Legrand and Doyle's Sherlock Holmes both solve mysteries through observation and logic, but they are very different kinds of characters. Compare and contrast the two. Which one did you find more compelling and why?

· Silas Marner: Do you think that Silas Marner is more of a fairy tale or a realistic novel? Give some specific examples from the novel that support your argument. OR Provide a detailed character sketch of one of the characters from the novel. What are they like? How do they change in response to what happens to them?